India. For ensuring nutritional security, it is not only important to increase per capita availability of foodgrains but also to ensure the right amounts of food items in the food basket of the common man. A thrust on horticulture products and protein-rich items is required for ensuring nutritional security.

Another critical issue is supply-chain management in agricultural marketing in India. It is necessary to evolve mechanisms for linking wholesale processing, logistics, and retailing with farm production activities so as to generate enhanced efficiency, better farm prices, etc. Recently the government allowed ***FDI in retail***, which can pave the way for investment in new technology and marketing of agricultural produce in India. ***Areas of importance may be seen as given below*** –

a. Need for stable and consistent policies where markets play an appropriate role,
b. Private investment in infrastructure is stepped up,
c. The public distribution system (PDS) is revamped,
d. Food price and food stock management improves,
e. And a predictable trade policy is adopted for agriculture.
f. The above-given initiatives need to be coupled with skill development and better research and development (R&D) along with improved delivery of credit, seeds, etc.

INDUSTRY AND INFRASTRUCTURE

The capital goods sector remained weak for the second consecutive year. **Negative growth** was not only experienced across the sub-sectors of the capital goods segment but was also more persistent with only two months in the last twelve months recording positive growth. The production of key capital goods such as machinery and equipment, electrical machinery, and transport segments contracted owing to deceleration in investment, a decline in new projects, and import competition. High interest rates and slower growth in household or retail credit resulted in slower growth in consumer durables.